

Guest Complaint & Service Recovery SOP

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Owner Department	Guest Relations
Category	SOP
Applies To	Guest Relations, Front Office, Food & Beverage and Duty Managers
Supersedes	SOP-GR-01 v1.0

1. Purpose

A well-handled complaint often turns an unhappy guest into a loyal one. This SOP gives every guest-facing colleague the same approach, the same limits and the same escalation path.

2. Handling complaints

2.1 The CARE model

Complaints must be handled using the CARE model: Calm, Acknowledge, Resolve, Echo back.

2.2 In practice

Stay calm and listen without interrupting; acknowledge the guest's feelings; agree a resolution; then echo back what was agreed so that the guest leaves the conversation certain of the next step.

2.3 Logging

Every complaint must be logged in the Guest Incident Log within 30 minutes, including the resolution offered.

3. Service recovery authority

3.1 Guest Relations and Front Office

Guest Relations Executives and Front Office Associates may offer service recovery up to USD 50 per stay; higher amounts require Duty Manager approval.

3.2 Duty Manager

The Duty Manager may approve service recovery up to USD 300 per stay; above this amount, the Hotel Manager must approve.

3.3 Typical recovery options

Situation	Typical recovery
Delayed room readiness	Coffee and pastry voucher or late check-out

Situation	Typical recovery
Noise disturbance	Room move and a breakfast credit
Billing error	Immediate correction and a written apology
Room quality issue	Room move and an amenity

4. Assessment

4.1 Role-play

Guest Relations Executives must demonstrate complaint handling in a role-play covering a billing dispute and a room-quality complaint.

5. Escalation

5.1 Sensitive complaints

Complaints involving safety, discrimination or data privacy must be escalated to the Duty Manager immediately, regardless of value.

Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of changes
1.0	2024-09-01	Initial complaint handling SOP.
2.0	2026-03-01	Service recovery limit for Guest Relations and Front Office reduced from USD 100 to USD 50 per stay.